



Convention
on Wetlands



Ramsar Sites

Wetlands of International Importance



Conserve



Protect



Sustain



Preserve

Key Facts • State-wise List • Latest Updates

Under the Guidance of
Vipulendra Tripathi Sir



For UPSC | BPSC | UPPSC |
SSC | State PSC & Other Exams



Exam Oriented
Content



Well Researched
& Updated



1 WHAT IS A RAMSAR SITE?

A Ramsar Site is a wetland of **international importance** designated under the **Convention on Wetlands** (Ramsar Convention)



Objective

The **conservation** and **wise use** of wetlands.

Key Features



Wetlands having **ecological, hydrological, botanical, zoological, limnological and biodiversity** value.



Supports **rich biodiversity** including rare and migratory species.



Helps in maintaining **ecological balance** and sustainable development.



Promotes **wise use** of wetlands for the benefit of present and future generations.



Wetlands include **lakes, rivers, marshes, swamps, peatlands, mangroves, coral reefs, estuaries**, etc.



2 WHY IS IT CALLED “RAMSAR”?

The Convention on Wetlands is called “Ramsar” because it was signed in the city of **Ramsar, Iran**.



Ramsar, Iran



Historical Facts

- Signed on:
2 February 1971
- Entered into force on:
21 December 1975



About the Convention

- An intergovernmental treaty for the **conservation and wise use of wetlands**.
- Aims to **halt the worldwide loss of wetlands** and their biodiversity.
- Works through **national actions and international cooperation**.



Convention
on Wetlands



World Wetlands Day is celebrated every year on
2 February.



3 INDIA AND RAMSAR CONVENTION



India became a Contracting Party on **1 February 1982**.



India is committed to the **conservation** and **wise use** of wetlands.



India is one of the most active members of the Ramsar Convention.



Convention
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KEY FACTS (INDIA)



Total Ramsar Sites
in India
100
(till 10 July 2026)



Total Ramsar Area
(India)
≈13.88
lakh hectares

IMPORTANCE OF WETLANDS



Help in flood control and storm protection



Aid in groundwater recharge and water purification



Support rich biodiversity and provide habitat to migratory birds and aquatic life



Act as carbon sinks and help in climate regulation



Support livelihoods of millions of people (fisheries, agriculture, tourism, etc.)

4 LATEST RAMSAR SITES (TILL 10 JULY 2026)



India has **100 Ramsar Sites** till 10 July 2026.
The most recent additions are:

1

Patna Bird Sanctuary

📍 Uttar Pradesh

Important habitat for migratory birds and aquatic fauna.



2

Chhari-Dhand Wetland

📍 Gujarat

A unique wetland ecosystem in the arid region.



3

Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary

📍 Uttar Pradesh

Home to a wide variety of resident and migratory birds.



4

Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal)

📍 Uttar Pradesh

Declared in June 2026.

100th Ramsar Site of India.



These additions reflect India's continued commitment towards wetland conservation and biodiversity protection.

5 FIRST RAMSAR SITES OF INDIA

★ The first Ramsar Sites of India were designated in **1981**.

1 Chilika Lake

📍 Odisha



- Asia's largest brackish water lagoon.
- Supports rich biodiversity, fisheries and migratory birds.
- Home to **Irrawaddy dolphins**.



2 Keoladeo National Park

📍 Rajasthan



- Also known as **Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary**.
- A man-made wetland.
- Important habitat for thousands of resident and migratory birds.



Significance of Early Designation

- ✓ Recognized the international importance of these wetlands.
- ✓ Strengthened India's commitment towards wetland conservation.
- ✓ Laid the foundation for protection of other wetlands in the country.

IMPORTANT EXAM FACTS



First Indian Ramsar Sites : Chilika Lake & Keoladeo National Park (**1981**)



India joined Ramsar Convention : **1 February 1982**



World Wetlands Day : **2 February**



Largest Ramsar Site in India : **Sundarban Wetland**



Smallest Ramsar Site in India : **Renuka Wetland** (Himachal Pradesh)



Total Ramsar Sites in India (till 10 July 2026) : **100**

6 IMPORTANT EXAM FACTS – QUICK REVISION



Ramsar Convention signed : **2 February 1971**



Place : **Ramsar, Iran**



Convention entered into force : **21 December 1975**



India became a Contracting Party : **1 February 1982**



Total Ramsar Sites in India (till 10 July 2026) : **100**



Total Ramsar area in India : **≈13.88 lakh hectares**



First Ramsar Sites of India : **Chilika Lake & Keoladeo National Park (1981)**



100th Ramsar Site of India : **Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal), Uttar Pradesh (June 2026)**



State with highest number of Ramsar Sites : **Tamil Nadu (20)**



Largest Ramsar Site in India : **Sundarban Wetland**



Smallest Ramsar Site in India : **Renuka Wetland** (Himachal Pradesh)

Why Wetlands Matter?



Flood control



Groundwater recharge



Carbon sequestration



Biodiversity conservation



Climate regulation



Livelihood support

7 STATE-WISE RAMSAR SITES IN INDIA

(Updated till 10 July 2026)



Total Ramsar Sites in India: **100** | Total Ramsar Area: **≈13.88 lakh hectares**

#	State / UT	No. of Sites	#	State / UT	No. of Sites
1	Tamil Nadu	20	14	Bihar	2
2	Uttar Pradesh	13	15	Haryana	2
3	Punjab	6	16	Karnataka	2
4	Gujarat	5	17	Himachal Pradesh	3
5	Jammu & Kashmir	5	18	Chhattisgarh	2
6	Odisha	5	19	Mizoram	2
7	Kerala	4	20	Tripura	2
8	Maharashtra	4	21	Goa	1
9	Madhya Pradesh	4	22	Sikkim	1
10	West Bengal	3	23	Uttarakhand	1
11	Rajasthan	3	24	Telangana	1
12	Andhra Pradesh	2	25	Ladakh	1
13	Assam	2	26	Delhi	1



State with highest Ramsar Sites: **Tamil Nadu (20)**



Note: Total = 100 Ramsar Sites in India (as on 10 July 2026).

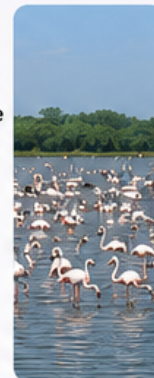
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IMPORTANT RAMSAR SITES – STATE WISE

(Selected Examples)

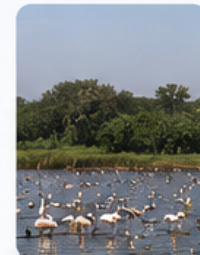
TAMIL NADU (20)

- Point Calimere
- Pallikarainai Marsh
- Pichavaram Mangroves
- Gulf of Mannar Marine Biosphere
- Vedanthangal Bird Sanctuary
- Vembannur Wetland
- Karikili Bird Sanctuary
- Udhayamarthandapuram Bird Sanctuary
- Vaduvur Bird Sanctuary
- Koonthakulam Bird Sanctuary
- & others...



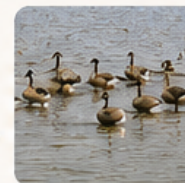
UTTAR PRADESH (13)

- Upper Ganga River
- Nawabganj (Shaheed Chandra Shekhar Azad Bird Sanctuary)
- Saman Bird Sanctuary
- Samaspur Bird Sanctuary
- Sandi Bird Sanctuary
- Parvati Arga Bird Sanctuary
- Bakhira Wildlife Sanctuary
- Haiderpur Wetland
- Sur Sarovar
- Patna Bird Sanctuary
- Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary
- Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal)**
- & one more notified wetland



PUNJAB (6)

- Harikeri Wetland
- Kanjli Wetland
- Nangal Wildlife Sanctuary
- Ropar Wetland
- Beas Conservation Reserve
- Shiva Wetland



GUJARAT (5)

- Nalsarovar Bird Sanctuary
- Thol Lake Wildlife Sanctuary
- Khijadia Wildlife Sanctuary
- Wadhvana Wetland
- Chhari-Dhand Wetland**



ODISHA (5)

- Chilika Lake
- Bhitarkanika Mangroves
- Ansupa Lake
- Tampara Lake
- Hirakud Reservoir



WEST BENGAL (3)

- Sundarban Wetland
- East Kolkata Wetlands
- Santragachi Jheel



Other States / UTs (Examples)

- ◆ Kerala (4): Sasthamkotta Lake, Ashtamudi Lake, Vembanad Kol, Koonthakulam
- ◆ Rajasthan (3): Sambhar Lake, Keoladeo National Park, Menar
- ◆ Jammu & Kashmir (5): Wular Lake, Hokersar, Surinsar-Mansar, Shallabugh, Hygam
- ◆ Madhya Pradesh (4): Bhoj Wetland, Sakhya Sagar, Sirpur Wetland, Yashwant Sagar
- ◆ Maharashtra (4): Thane Creek, Nandur Madhmeshwar, Lonar Lake, Karanja Wetland
- ◆ And many more...



These wetlands are vital for biodiversity conservation, migratory birds, water security and livelihood support.



9 MORE RAMSAR SITES – STATE WISE (SELECTED)

KERALA (4)

- Sasthamkotta Lake
- Ashtamudi Lake
- Vembanad Kol Wetland
- Koonthankulam Bird Sanctuary



MAHARASHTRA (4)

- Nandur Madhmeshwar
- Lonar Lake
- Thane Creek
- Karanja Wetland



MADHYA PRADESH (4)

- Bhoj Wetland
- Sakhya Sagar
- Sirpur Wetland
- Yashwant Sagar



PUNJAB (6) – contd.

- Beas Conservation Reserve
- Keshopur-Miani Community Reserve
- Harike Wetland
- Ropar Wetland
- Kanjli Wetland
- Nangal Wildlife Sanctuary



RAJASTHAN (3)

- Sambhar Lake
- Keoladeo National Park
- Menar Wetland



JAMMU & KASHMIR (5)

- Wular Lake
- Hokersar Wetland
- Surinsar-Mansar Lakes
- Shallabugh Wetland
- Hygam Wetland



OTHER STATES / UTs

- Andhra Pradesh (2)** : Kolleru Lake, Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary
- Assam (2)** : Deepor Beel, Loktak Lake
- Bihar (2)** : Kanwar Lake, Sarsai Nawar Jheel
- Haryana (2)** : Bhindawas Wildlife Sanctuary, Sultanpur National Park
- Karnataka (2)** : Ranganathittu Bird Sanctuary, Attiveri Bird Sanctuary
- Himachal Pradesh (3)** : Pong Dam Lake, Renuka Wetland, Chandra Taal
- Chhattisgarh (2)** : Kanger Valley National Park, Achanakmar-Amarkantak
- Mizoram (2)** : Palak Lake, Rih Dil
- Tripura (2)** : Rudrasagar Lake, Trishna Wildlife Sanctuary

- Goa (1)** : Nanda Lake
- Sikkim (1)** : Khecheopalri Wetland
- Uttarakhand (1)** : Asan Barrage
- Telangana (1)** : Pakhal Lake
- Ladakh (1)** : Tso Kar
- Delhi (1)** : Najafgarh Jheel

KEY TAKEAWAY



Ramsar Sites are a national treasure. They conserve biodiversity, support livelihoods and ensure ecological balance for a sustainable future.



10 RAMSAR SITES – IMPORTANT FACTS & REVISION

IMPORTANT FACTS (QUICK REVISION)

	Ramsar Convention signed on	: 2 February 1971
	Place	: Ramsar, Iran
	Convention entered into force	: 21 December 1975
	India became a Contracting Party	: 1 February 1982
	Total Ramsar Sites in India (till 10 July 2026)	: 100
	Total Ramsar Area in India	: ≈13.88 lakh hectares
	First Ramsar Sites of India (1981)	: Chilika Lake & Keoladeo National Park
	100 th Ramsar Site of India (June 2026)	: Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal), Uttar Pradesh
	State with highest number of Ramsar Sites	: Tamil Nadu (20)
	Largest Ramsar Site in India	: Sundarban Wetland
	Smallest Ramsar Site in India	: Renuka Wetland (Himachal Pradesh)
	World Wetlands Day	: 2 February

IMPORTANCE OF RAMSAR SITES

- ✓ Conserve biodiversity and unique ecosystems.
- ✓ Provide habitat to migratory and resident birds.
- ✓ Maintain ecological balance and climate regulation.
- ✓ Help in flood control and groundwater recharge.
- ✓ Support fisheries, agriculture, tourism and livelihoods.
- ✓ Promote wise use and sustainable development.



ONE-LINER REVISION

- ★ Ramsar Convention → 1971
- ★ Place → Ramsar, Iran
- ★ India joined → 1 Feb 1982
- ★ World Wetlands Day → 2 Feb
- ★ Total Ramsar Sites in India → 100
- ★ First Sites → Chilika Lake & Keoladeo National Park (1981)
- ★ 100th Site → Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal), U.P.
- ★ Highest by State → Tamil Nadu (20)
- ★ Largest → Sundarban Wetland
- ★ Smallest → Renuka Wetland

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Protect wetlands today for a better and sustainable tomorrow.

